

LCD Writing tablet

Boogie Board LCD writing tablet is a tree-friendly alternative to paper notepads. A push of a button erases the written stuff

Wii2HDMI

Wii2HDMI claims to convert the Nintendo Wii's output to an HDMI connection in a compact adapter

An alert consumer is a 'king' consumer

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Kautilya was one of the earliest to discuss in his famous book "Arthashastra" about the call for consumer consciousness and safeguards. Although in Kautilya's Arthashastra, stringent rules were placed for the trade and industry and punishments for exploitation were set out. But, there was no organized and systematic mechanism safeguarding the interests of the consumers in India until the Consumer Act was enacted to ease out the tensions of the consumer. Consumer is said to be the king but really speaking it's only the smart and informed consumer who is king". With the growth of private sector, changing business ethics and marketing strategies there is a greater need for a consumer to be informed to invoke his rights.

It's been more than two decades since the Consumer Act has been enacted but still it has not been able to make the desired impact. The big companies make mockery of it time and again taking advantage of ill informed consumer and ill equipped legal system. Not only the sound functioning of product but consumer must be aware of the price, sale and purchase conditions of goods and the health and security aspects also. There are many goods which are sold in the market without much information about their quality, quantity, storage conditions and safety features. Manufacturers or producers and retailers seldom follow the safety regulations in the products like, lamps, batteries, footwear, electrical equipments, wires, cement, LPG cylinders, stoves, switches, plugs, sockets etc. leading to many fatal accidents or health implications.

The Consumer Protection Act, which has been defined as "the Magna Carta of Consumers", spells out six consumer rights: Right to Safety, Right to Information, Right to Choice, Right to

Representation, Right to Redress, and Right to Consumer Education. India has the biggest consumer movement today due to the efforts of consumer organizations and the establishment of consumer courts. In the age of internet it's not very difficult to be informed. And yes, to be informed means not only when duped but before purchasing the product for which you are spending your hard earned money.

Consumers have the societal accountability of exposing the manufacture, supplier or the service provider for resorting to illegal trade malpractices. Unethical notings like "Goods once sold will never be taken back" are in sharp contrast to the practice in some of the developed countries, where the sellers declare, "In case you are not fully satisfied with our product, you can bring the same to us within a month for either replacement or return of your money." Why the buyer be beware and why not the seller? This is the result of consumer consciousness. Consumers have to appreciate their role and significance. The consumer movements can be winner movements only with our active participation by knowing our rights and enforcing them. It requires a voluntary effort involving the participation of one and all. If consumers remain passive, they will keep on to be exploited. It is necessary that consumers take action with unity to get a fair deal and timely redressal. An alert consumer is a 'king' consumer. **d**

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COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Case File #67

Acer Aspire 4736Z Touch Pad not working

I have purchased an Acer Aspire 4736Z computer in January 2010. Once earlier the laptop was sent to them with subject complaint in February 2010. The laptop is again giving same problem. Can I ask for the replacement of the laptop. Is it legally covered that product giving such recurrent problem may get replacement. Please guide me. Thanks.Pijush Kanti

Answer by Consumermate:

Dear Piyush,

In the first instance, you cannot insist for the replacement of your laptop itself, but definitely for the specific part causing the problem. However, if the problem persists, you can ask for a replacement. We would suggest you to keep a written track record of all your complaints, services done and parts replaced.

Case File #74

Acer laptops-Poor Service

Question:

I had purchased an Acer laptop 3 years back. After 6 months, I was unable to see the screen properly. The screen used to be white and I had to restart the PC. Recently, I had given it to Reliable Computers in Vile Parle, Mumbai. They said there was a problem with the IC, and charged me Rs. 5,500 for replacing the IC with a new one. It was fine for about three days, after which the problem resumed. I spoke to them over the phone. They wanted to take my laptop again, but I refused as I don't trust them anymore. I wanted them to repair in front of me which they refused. I need a resolution for this as I feel they have cheated me. I want strict action to be taken against them. Please help.

Nancy Samuel